

Neurodiversity Concept		
Lesson Date	Lesson Leads	Slides
Day 1	Teacher/Counselor	
Logistics		
Materials		
Paper	Teacher: Guides students without introducing abstract vocabulary and teaches about the concept of neurodiversity and how it applies everywhere Students: Participate in discussions and activities to learn about neurodiversity.	
Crayons/Markers		
Picture book		
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (3 mins)	Begin with questions: • “Would you rather draw or build?” • “Would you rather be loud or quiet?” • “Would you rather play alone or with friends?” Have students answer and introduce <i>neurodiversity</i> : everyone’s answers are different because our brains are different.	
Read storybook (7 mins)	I See Things Differently: Helping Kids Understand Autism and Neurodiversity PDF	
Discuss story (5 mins)	What are some differences in our brains that you learned from the book? • Some people like noise, others like quiet • Some learn by moving, others by sitting still • Some think quickly, others take more time • There are different names we call the different ways our brains work The book shows that all brains are different, and that’s what makes each of us special.	
Activity (10 mins)	Drawing Activity: Show that even when everyone does the same thing, their brains work differently. 1. Give students the drawing supplies 2. Tell them simple instructions to draw a circle, add two lines, and attach another circle to the side of it 3. Have everyone hold their drawing up. Even though we had the same instructions, our brains came up with different ideas. This shows how we think differently!	

Equality and Fairness (Accommodations)		
Lesson Date	Lesson Lead	Slides
Day 2	Teacher/Counselor	
Logistics		
Materials		
Slides	Teacher: Guides students on fairness vs. equality and teaches about how different people need different accommodations Students: Participate in discussions and activities to learn about the difference between fairness and equality based on how we are all different.	
Storybook		
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (10 mins)	Begin with questions: • If one person is cold, should everyone wear a jacket? • If one person can't see the board, should everyone get glasses? • If one person is hungry, should we all eat again? Have students answer these questions and transition to introducing the topic of needs and equality in neurodivergence. • Sometimes giving everyone the SAME thing isn't actually fair. • FAIR means giving everyone what they NEED. • Some people need different things to learn or feel comfortable because we all have different brains.	
Read storybook (10 mins)	EQUITY VS. EQUALITY: Oliver Octopus and the Unwinnable Game (video)	
Discussion (10 mins)	Ask the students about why the children in the book felt that different situations were “unfair.” • Stress the importance of everyone needing different things • Fairness comes from getting what you need rather than what everyone else gets • As we learned, everyone thinks and needs different things!	

Communication		
Lesson Date	Lesson Lead	Slides
Day 3	Teacher/Counselor	
Logistics		
Materials		
Slides	Teacher: Teaches students about different communication accommodations for different people and guides them on the applications Students: Participate in discussions and activities to learn about the different modes of communication and accept them	
Worksheet		
Storybook		
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Read storybook (10 mins)	Do You Speak Fish?	
Discussion + Connection (5 mins)	Discuss the story and what happened: - The boy tried to talk, but the fish couldn't respond → this doesn't mean the fish can't communicate, he just communicates differently! Connect to the communication topic: - Sometimes people don't use words: they might use actions, expressions, or need more time - We may need to listen in different ways to understand others - Just like in the book, everyone has their own way of communicating, and that's okay!!	
Activity (10 mins)	Slides: Activity to show students different modes of communication that different people may need - Show students different modes of communication - Allow students to understand why certain people may require certain forms of communication - Look at pictures and attempt to interpret what a person is trying to convey, even if they are communicating differently.	
Wrap-up/Final Discussion (5 mins)	Just like our brains are different, our communication and the way we talk to each other are different, too - It is important to respect everyone, regardless of the way they communicate - To be good people, we must: - Be patient, Pay attention (look, listen, think), Try different ways to understand	

Application of Concepts		
Lesson Date	Lesson Lead	Slides
Day 4	Teacher/Counselor	
Logistics		
Materials		
Slides	Teacher: Helps students apply what they've learned over the past 3 days in their everyday lives to understand how neurodiversity impacts everyone. Students: Participate in discussions and activities to learn about these applications and be respectful about them.	
Storybook		
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Quick Recall (5 mins)	Ask questions/reiterate what was learned the past few days: • We learned that all brains think differently • Because of these differences, we all NEED different things ◦ What we NEED v what is EQUAL is different ◦ Fairness is getting what you need • Because of differences in how we think, we may also communicate differently, and all ways are good! Today, we are going to learn about how these ideas show up in our everyday lives	
Video (5 mins)	Find a video that depicts a scenario in which someone is neurodivergent and needs to communicate differently, with appropriate accommodations.	
Discussion (4 mins)	Discuss what concepts we can apply to the video • What happened? • Connect what happened to neurodiversity + fairness + communication differences.	
Activity 1 (10 mins)	Identify which concepts learned apply to which scenarios and WHY: • A student covers their ears when the class gets a bit loud ◦ Different brains + Fairness ◦ They need something different (quiet) to feel okay • A student is confused but doesn't ask for help ◦ Communication + different brains ◦ They may not know how to ask or need support in a different way	

Commitment to Neurodiversity Acceptance		
Lesson Date	Lesson Lead	
Day 5	Teacher/Counselor	
Logistics		
	Teacher: Reviews EVERYTHING that has been learned so far and sums it up in a way that students can apply it to everyday life. Students: Participate in discussions and activities to learn about these applications and be respectful about them.	
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Quick Review/Discussion (10 mins)	Review all of the lessons from the previous 4 days and help kids remember what they had learned: • All of our brains are different • Everyone NEEDS different things, so not everything is equal, and that's okay! • Everyone communicates differently, and we must respect that.	
Activity (15 mins)	Have every student share at least one commitment or promise they will make to respect and accept neurodivergence. • Be patient and kind, • help others, • don't say "that's unfair." • listen in different ways Discuss how/why each one is important with the class.	